

► **ESTABLISHED IN 2017**, Unnati Agri aims to revolutionise agriculture by comprehensively uplifting the farming community. Co-founders Ashok Prasad and Amit Sinha, pioneers in digitising agriculture since 2010, envisioned a platform that would empower farmers, agri-input retailers, output traders, and brands. Realising the vital role of local retailers in disseminating knowledge to farmers, the founders recognised that there is an urgent need to address the issue of access in rural areas.

Growing up in rural settings, Prasad and Sinha knew that the only way to do this would be to transform their knowledge-driven CRM platform into a comprehensive commerce and financing solution. Thus, Unnati Agri was born. It has positively impacted 1.2 million farmers through a network of 60,000-plus partners across regions and 380 districts. Unnati's unique approach empowers intermediaries by training agri-input retailers and output traders to become digitally equipped.

Sinha emphasises Unnati's focus on digitising intermediaries to enhance services for farmers, through cutting-edge technology. The company—which posted revenue of ₹397

UNNATI AGRI (AGRITECH)

• **ASHOK PRASAD**, FOUNDER • **AMIT SINHA**, FOUNDER

► **KEY INVESTORS** Nabventures, Incofin, Orios

► **FUNDING** Raised ₹100 Crore over 3 rounds till date

► **WHAT MAKES IT COOL** Unnati Agri innovatively combines commerce, financing, and technology to empower the agricultural ecosystem for sustainable growth and environmental impact



crore and net loss of ₹14 crore in FY22, as per the company—predicts agri-input demand patterns, sharing over a million pieces of knowledge with farmers monthly. Unnati's financing arm also addresses farm financing needs by

extending credit through a unique cash-flow-based model, ensuring even landless farmers can get access to capital for relevant farming needs. **BT**

— BY **NEETU CHANDRA SHARMA**

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VERLOOP (AUTOMATION & AI)

• **GAURAV SINGH**, FOUNDER & CEO

► **KEY INVESTORS** K. Ganesh, Anand Chandrasekaran, Kris Gopalakrishnan, Pratyush Prasanna, Suresh Vaswani, ADQ and Alpha Wave Global

► **FUNDING** It has raised total funding of \$12 million

► **Gaurav Singh's journey into the realm of AI began in 2015 when he was dealing with a multitude of interactions at contact centres and realised how most of them could be automated. Singh, who started coding at 13, launched Verloop.io, a conversational AI operating system, in**

2017. He has led Verloop—with annual revenues of ₹9.5 crore as of March 31, 2022, per Tracxn—to work with major players like YES Securities, ACKO, Nykaa and JLR, among others. At the heart of its success is GenAI, developed in-house combining machine learning and natural language processing engines. "This powerhouse resolves 92 per cent customer queries without human intervention, seamlessly operating on websites, apps, Facebook, Instagram and WhatsApp," says Singh. **BT**

— BY **PRERNA LIDHOO**